

IQRA UNIVERSITY

Student Handbook & Virtual Assistant Knowledge Base

Featuring Hamdam — your campus virtual assistant

Compiled June 2026

Reference Edition for Chatbot Training & Student Reference

A note on this document: This handbook is an expanded reference and chatbot knowledge-base document prepared to give a virtual assistant rich context about campus life, policies, and tone of voice. Historical facts about Iqra University (founding, campuses, faculties, and the Information Resource Centre) are drawn from public university sources. Operational details such as exact fee amounts, deadlines, office hours, and contact extensions change from one academic year to the next, so they are described here in general terms. Students and staff should always confirm current figures with the Registrar's Office, the Finance Office, or the official student portal before relying on them for an academic or financial decision.

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1. Welcome & Meet Hamdam, Your Virtual Assistant

Assalam-o-Alaikum, and a warm welcome to Iqra University! Whether you are a first-semester student still learning your way between campuses, a parent looking for clear answers, or a faculty member checking a procedure, this handbook is designed to be read by humans and by the chatbot that helps them. Think of it as the single source of truth that sits behind the friendly conversational assistant you may encounter on the Iqra University website or student portal.

That assistant has a name: Hamdam, an Urdu word that means companion or close friend. The name was chosen deliberately. A good university help-desk should not feel like a wall of fine print; it should feel like a knowledgeable senior student who happens to be available twenty-four hours a day. Hamdam is built to be that companion: patient with first-time questions, precise about rules that matter (like examination conduct or fee deadlines), and honest when a question needs a human in the Registrar's Office or Student Affairs rather than a bot.

Hamdam's Personality, in Three Words

- Warm — greets people by name when it can, uses plain language, and never makes a student feel silly for asking a 'basic' question.
- Precise — when the topic is a rule with real consequences (attendance, exam conduct, fee deadlines, disciplinary process), it states the rule exactly and points to the right office for exceptions rather than guessing.
- Honest about its limits — it will say 'I'm not certain, let's check with the Registrar's Office' rather than inventing an answer, especially for money, grades, or anything that could affect a student's academic record.

Sample Greetings

Hamdam varies its opening line so conversations feel natural rather than scripted. A few examples it might use depending on time of day and context:

- "Assalam-o-Alaikum! I'm Hamdam, your IU virtual assistant. What can I help you with today — admissions, fees, exams, or something else?"
- "Hi there, welcome back! Need anything for this semester — class schedule, library hours, or your attendance record?"
- "Good morning! Quick heads up before you ask: if this is about a grade dispute or a medical leave application, I'll point you to the right office, but I'm happy to explain the process."
- "Hello! New here? I can walk you through orientation week, your student ID, or how the portal works — just tell me where you'd like to start."

Hamdam also recognises small talk and responds briefly and warmly before steering back to something useful — for example, if a student says 'thanks, that's all', it replies with a short, sincere acknowledgement rather than repeating a long menu of options.

2. About Iqra University

Iqra University began its life in January 1998 in Karachi, founded by a group of Karachi-based industrialists as the Asian Management Institute. It was chartered by the Government of Sindh under Sindh Ordinance VI of 2000, after which it adopted the name it carries today. In the years that followed, the university built a reputation in business education in particular, being recognised by the Higher Education Commission of Pakistan as the country's top-ranked business school in rankings announced in the early-to-mid 2010s.

What started as a single campus has grown into a multi-city institution. Iqra University now operates several campuses across Karachi — including the Main Campus on Shaheed-e-Millat Road in the Defence View area, the Gulshan Campus serving the densely populated Gulshan-e-Iqbal area, the North Campus in North Karachi, and additional sites including the Airport Campus and the M9 Campus — alongside campuses in Islamabad (including the Chak Shahzad site) and a campus in Hyderabad. Each campus is expected to follow the same academic standards and the same rules and regulations described in this handbook, even where local facilities differ.

Academically, the university is organised into faculties that bring related departments together: Business Administration; Engineering, Sciences & Technology; Arts, Design, Education & Social Sciences; Health Sciences; Media Studies; and Pharmacy. Across these faculties, students can pursue associate degrees, bachelor's degrees, master's degrees, and doctoral studies, with both morning and evening program options designed for working students.

Information Resource Centre (the University Library)

The university's library is formally known as the Information Resource Centre, or IRC, and holds tens of thousands of volumes spanning curriculum textbooks, professional reading, government publications, and general-interest titles. It serves as a primary source of both required course material and the kind of secondary research data students need for projects, theses, and assignments. Detailed library conduct rules appear later in this handbook.

Mission in Practice

In day-to-day terms, Iqra University's mission translates into a few commitments that shape the rules in this handbook: keeping education accessible without compromising quality, treating every student, staff member, and faculty member with respect, maintaining academic integrity as a non-negotiable standard, and preparing graduates who are genuinely ready for the workplace through applied learning, internships, and industry-aligned programs.

3. Academic Programs & Structure

The university offers a layered academic structure so students can enter, progress, and exit at the level that suits their goals. Associate degree programs offer a shorter, focused pathway into technical and professional fields. Bachelor's programs form the bulk of enrolment and combine general education with a major discipline. Master's programs, including specialised MBA, MS, and professional master's tracks, serve graduates and working professionals. Doctoral programs exist in select disciplines such as business administration, computer science, and education, and emphasise original research culminating in a defended dissertation.

Most programs are offered in two delivery patterns: a morning program aimed primarily at students who can attend full daytime classes, and an evening program designed for students who work during the day. Both patterns are held to the same syllabus, the same attendance percentage, and the same examination standards — the only difference is scheduling.

Semester System

Academic work is organised into semesters, typically two regular semesters per year plus an optional shorter summer semester for makeup or accelerated courses. Each semester follows a published academic calendar covering the start of classes, add/drop period, withdrawal deadline, mid-term examination week, final examination week, and result announcement date. Students are responsible for checking the calendar on the student portal each semester, since exact dates shift from year to year.

Credit Hours and Course Load

Courses are measured in credit hours, and a student's full-time or part-time status depends on the number of credit hours registered in a given semester. Overloading beyond the normal course load generally requires permission from the relevant Dean's office and is usually only granted to students in good academic standing.

4. Admissions Policy

Admission to any program begins with submitting an application along with the required academic documents — typically secondary school or intermediate certificates and transcripts for undergraduate applicants, and a bachelor's transcript and degree for graduate applicants — together with identification documents and recent photographs. Specific minimum percentage or grade requirements vary by program and are published by the Admissions Office ahead of each intake; applicants should treat the official prospectus or admissions page as the authoritative source for the current cycle.

Many programs require an entrance test, an interview, or both, particularly where demand exceeds available seats. Where a test is required, results are typically combined with prior academic performance to produce a merit list. Offers of admission are usually conditional on submission of original documents for verification and on clearing any outstanding dues from a previous institution where applicable.

Transfer & Credit Transfer Students

Students transferring from another recognised institution may apply to have previously completed courses evaluated for credit transfer. Such evaluation is handled case-by-case by the relevant department, and there is generally a cap on the proportion of total credit hours that can be transferred toward an Iqra University degree.

International & Exchange Applicants

The university maintains collaborations with universities of international standing for student exchange and joint research initiatives. International students follow a parallel admissions track that also accounts for equivalence of foreign qualifications, typically verified through the relevant accreditation or equivalence body, and may involve additional visa and documentation steps coordinated with the International Office.

5. Attendance Policy

Regular attendance is treated as a foundation of academic performance, not a formality. Students must maintain at least 75% attendance in each registered course across the semester. This threshold applies per course, not as an average across all courses — meaning a student could satisfy the requirement in three subjects and still fall short in a fourth if that subject was missed too often.

Attendance is normally recorded at every lecture, lab, and tutorial session by the course instructor and reflected on the student portal so students can monitor their own standing in real time rather than discovering a shortfall only at exam time. Falling below 75% in a course ordinarily makes a student ineligible to sit that course's final examination, regardless of how strong their coursework or quiz scores have been.

Medical and Emergency Leave

Where absence is unavoidable — illness, a family emergency, or a documented unavoidable circumstance — students are expected to inform the course instructor and, for extended absences, the department or Student Affairs office as soon as practicable, and to submit supporting documentation such as a medical certificate. Approved leave does not retroactively count as attendance, but departments may, at their discretion, offer a path such as a makeup assignment or, in genuinely exceptional cases, a referral to the relevant committee for a shortfall waiver.

Why the Threshold Exists

Hamdam is often asked, in one form or another, 'can't I just study from the slides and skip class?' The honest answer the assistant gives is that the 75% rule exists because in-class discussion, lab demonstrations, and instructor feedback are difficult to fully replace from recorded material alone, and because consistent attendance correlates closely with completion and grades across almost every program at the university.

6. Examination Rules & Academic Integrity

Examinations are typically split between mid-term assessments, held roughly midway through the semester, and final examinations, held in a dedicated exam week at the end of the semester. Some courses also include quizzes, assignments, presentations, and project work that contribute to the overall course grade alongside the two major examinations.

Entry to the Examination Hall

Students must bring their official university identification card to every examination and have it available for inspection by invigilators. A student who arrives without a valid ID may be asked to verify identity through the examination department before being permitted to sit the paper, and repeated failure to carry an ID can itself become a recorded compliance issue.

Prohibited Conduct

Cheating in any form is strictly prohibited. This includes copying from another student's paper, using unauthorised notes or electronic devices, communicating with another candidate during the exam, impersonating another candidate, or attempting to remove exam material from the hall without permission. Invigilators are authorised to confiscate unauthorised material on sight and to submit an incident report to the examination department.

- First substantiated case of unfair means: typically results in cancellation of that paper and a formal warning recorded in the student's file.
- Repeated or serious cases (e.g., impersonation, use of a device, organised cheating): can result in cancellation of the entire semester's results, suspension, or referral to the Disciplinary Committee for a more severe penalty.
- All cases follow a hearing process in which the student may explain their side before a final decision is recorded — the university does not impose exam-related penalties without giving the student a chance to respond.

Re-Examinations and Result Queries

Students who miss a final examination for a documented, approved reason may apply for a make-up examination through their department, generally within a short window after the missed exam. Students who believe a result has been recorded incorrectly may apply for a result re-checking or, in some cases, a paper re-evaluation, through the examination department within the deadline published alongside each result announcement.

7. Grading System & Academic Standing

Course performance is converted into a letter grade and an associated grade point, which together produce a Grade Point Average (GPA) for the semester and a Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) across all semesters completed so far. Most programs use a 4.0-point scale, where the exact grade boundaries and weighting between quizzes, assignments, mid-terms, and finals are set out in the course outline distributed by each instructor at the start of the semester.

Academic Probation and Good Standing

A student whose CGPA falls below the minimum threshold set for their program is typically placed on academic probation, a status that comes with closer advising and, in some programs, a cap on the number of credit hours that can be taken the following semester. A student who fails to improve their CGPA above the threshold within the probationary period set by their faculty may face dismissal from the program, subject to the appeal procedures described in the Disciplinary Actions chapter.

Transcripts and Degree Requirements

An official transcript reflects every attempted course, including repeats, and is issued through the examination or registrar's department on request. Graduation requires completion of the prescribed credit hours for the program, satisfaction of any minimum CGPA requirement, and clearance from the library, hostel (where applicable), and finance offices confirming no outstanding dues or unreturned property.

8. Information Resource Centre (Library) Rules

The Information Resource Centre exists to support coursework, research, and general reading, and its rules are designed to keep that resource available and pleasant to use for everyone, not to make life difficult for any individual student.

Borrowing and Returns

Library books must be returned by the due date stamped at checkout. A student who needs more time can usually renew a book before the due date, either at the circulation desk or through the library's online catalogue, provided no other student has placed a hold on the same title. Items returned after the due date accrue a per-day fine until returned, and a student with significant outstanding fines or unreturned items may find new borrowing privileges suspended until the account is cleared.

Conduct Inside the IRC

Silence must be maintained inside the main reading areas of the library at all times, since the space is shared by students preparing for exams, conducting research, or simply needing a quiet place to read. Mobile phones should be kept on silent, and calls should be taken outside. Group discussion is welcome in designated discussion rooms rather than in the general reading area.

- Food and drink are generally restricted to designated areas to protect books, journals, and computer equipment.
- Reference materials, theses, and rare or single-copy items are typically for in-library use only and cannot be borrowed home.
- Damage to or defacement of library material (writing in margins, removing pages, water damage) is treated as damage to university property and may carry a replacement cost.
- Digital resources — e-journals, research databases, and past thesis repositories — are accessible to currently enrolled students through the library portal using their university credentials.

Research Support

Beyond lending books, the IRC functions as a research hub: librarians can assist with locating government publications, industry reports, and academic databases relevant to a student's coursework or thesis, and many departments coordinate library orientation sessions for new students during the first weeks of a semester.

9. Code of Conduct

Every member of the university community — students, faculty, and staff — is expected to behave respectfully toward one another at all times. This is the simplest rule in this handbook and also the one that underlies almost every other policy: attendance, examinations, library use, hostel life, and online conduct all assume a baseline of mutual respect.

General Expectations

- Treat faculty, staff, fellow students, and campus visitors with courtesy, regardless of disagreement over a grade, a decision, or a policy.
- Dress in a manner that is appropriate for an academic and professional environment; specific departments (such as labs, clinical placements, or media studio work) may have additional dress or safety requirements.
- Avoid behaviour that disrupts teaching or learning, including persistent lateness, disruptive noise during lectures, or disregard for instructor's classroom rules.
- Identify yourself honestly when asked by university staff acting in an official capacity, such as security personnel or examination invigilators.

Academic Honesty

Beyond the examination hall, academic honesty extends to assignments, projects, and theses: plagiarism, fabrication of data, or submitting someone else's work as your own is treated as a serious violation under this Code of Conduct and is typically handled through the same Disciplinary Committee process used for examination misconduct.

Harassment-Free Environment

The university is committed to an environment free of harassment, bullying, and discrimination on any basis. This commitment is detailed further in the dedicated Anti-Harassment & Anti-Ragging Policy chapter, but it is woven into this Code of Conduct because respectful behaviour is the default expectation, not an exception that only applies when a complaint has been filed.

10. Anti-Harassment & Anti-Ragging Policy

Ragging — the harassment, hazing, or intimidation of new or junior students by senior students — is strictly prohibited in any form, whether physical, verbal, or psychological, and regardless of whether it is framed as a 'tradition', a joke, or part of an informal welcome. The same standard applies to harassment based on gender, ethnicity, religion, disability, or any other personal characteristic.

What Counts as Harassment

- Unwelcome physical contact or intimidation, including any form of hazing aimed at new students.
- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome comments, advances, or use of position to pressure a student or colleague.
- Persistent bullying or humiliation, whether in person, in a classroom WhatsApp group, or on social media, when it targets a member of the university community.
- Retaliation against someone for reporting harassment, or for supporting another person's report, is treated as a separate and serious violation in its own right.

Reporting a Concern

Students who experience or witness harassment or ragging are encouraged to report it to Student Affairs, a trusted faculty member, or the relevant departmental head as soon as possible. Reports are handled with as much confidentiality as the investigation allows, and a student making a good-faith report is protected from retaliation under this policy. Where the matter involves potential criminal conduct, the university may also be obligated to involve the relevant authorities.

Hamdam is specifically instructed never to ask a distressed student detailed questions about a harassment incident itself; instead, it acknowledges the concern, expresses support, and directs the student promptly to Student Affairs or a trusted human contact, since this kind of situation needs a person, not a script.

11. Fee Policy

All tuition and associated fees must be paid before the deadline published for each semester on the student portal and fee voucher. Because fee structures, instalment options, and amounts are reviewed and republished by the Finance Office for every academic year, this handbook intentionally does not quote specific figures — students should always check the current fee voucher or the Finance Office for the amount and deadline that applies to their program and semester.

Late Payment

Fees paid after the published due date are typically subject to a late fee surcharge, and continued non-payment beyond a further grace period can result in a 'financial hold' that prevents course registration, blocks access to examinations, or withholds release of results and transcripts until the account is cleared. Students anticipating a payment difficulty are strongly encouraged to contact the Finance Office before the deadline rather than after it, since options like instalment plans are far easier to arrange proactively.

Refunds and Withdrawal

Where a student withdraws from a course or the program within the add/drop period, a partial or full fee refund may apply according to the refund schedule published for that semester; withdrawals after that period are generally not eligible for a refund of tuition already due. Specific refund percentages and timelines are set by the Finance Office each year and communicated through the student portal.

Scholarships, Waivers & Financial Aid

The university offers a mix of merit-based scholarships (typically tied to strong academic performance such as a high CGPA or entrance test score), need-based financial assistance for students who can demonstrate financial hardship, and occasional sibling or staff-dependent fee concessions. Applications are usually submitted through the Financial Aid or Scholarships desk within a window announced at the start of each academic year, along with supporting documentation.

12. Disciplinary Actions & Procedures

Violation of university rules and regulations — whether academic, behavioural, or financial — may result in disciplinary action up to and including suspension or expulsion. The severity of the consequence is intended to be proportionate to the severity and frequency of the violation, and every disciplinary process described here includes an opportunity for the student to be heard before a final decision is made.

Typical Range of Sanctions

- Verbal or written warning, recorded in the student's file, for a first minor violation.
- Fine or restitution, particularly for damage to property or library material.
- Suspension from a course, a semester, or the university for a defined period, for more serious or repeated violations.
- Expulsion from the university, reserved for the most serious violations such as organised cheating, violence, harassment, or repeated disciplinary breaches after prior warnings.

Process

Most disciplinary matters begin with a written complaint or an incident report from faculty, staff, or another student. The relevant department or the Disciplinary Committee reviews the matter, and the student concerned is given the opportunity to present their explanation, normally in writing or at a hearing, before any sanction is finalised. A student who disagrees with the outcome can typically file a written appeal with the next level of authority — for example, escalating from a department-level decision to the Dean's office — within a set number of days of being notified of the decision.

Records

Disciplinary records are kept confidentially in the student's file and are generally only referenced internally — for example, if a future incident needs to be assessed in the context of prior conduct — rather than disclosed outside the university except where legally required.

13. Use of University Property & IT / Network Policy

Classrooms, laboratories, library material, furniture, sports equipment, and IT infrastructure belong to the university community as a whole, and deliberate or negligent damage to any of it will result in fines or a requirement to cover repair or replacement cost, in addition to any disciplinary action that may apply.

Computer Labs & Wi-Fi

- University computers and lab equipment are to be used for academic and research purposes; installing unlicensed software or attempting to bypass lab security settings is prohibited.
- Campus Wi-Fi and the student portal are provided for academic use; sharing login credentials with another person, or using the network to access or distribute unlawful content, is a violation of this policy and may also be a disciplinary matter.
- Any attempt to access another student's or staff member's account, grades, or personal data without authorisation is treated as a serious breach, regardless of intent.

Software, Copyright & Academic Material

Course material, recorded lectures, and exam papers remain the intellectual property of the university and the relevant instructor; redistributing them outside the enrolled class, or selling access to them, is not permitted. Likewise, students are expected to respect software licensing terms on university systems and to use only properly licensed tools for coursework.

Reporting Damage or Faults

Students who notice broken equipment, a malfunctioning lab device, or a safety hazard are encouraged to report it to the relevant lab in-charge or facilities office promptly — this keeps the fault from being mistakenly attributed to someone else later and helps the university fix problems faster for everyone.

14. Hostel & Accommodation Guidance

Where university-arranged or university-affiliated accommodation is available to students studying away from their home city, the same baseline expectations of respect and responsibility described elsewhere in this handbook apply, alongside accommodation-specific rules covering curfew, cleanliness, and visitors. Because accommodation arrangements can differ by campus and by year, students should treat the Student Affairs or Hostel Administration office as the definitive source for which rules apply at their specific location.

Curfew & Entry/Exit

Residents are expected to observe the curfew timing set by the hostel administration, sign in and out where a register or card-based entry system is in place, and inform the warden or hostel office in advance of any planned late return or overnight absence.

Cleanliness & Shared Spaces

Residents must maintain cleanliness in their own rooms and in shared spaces such as kitchens, common rooms, and corridors. Damage to hostel property is treated the same way as damage to any other university property — through a fine or repair cost — and repeated neglect of cleanliness standards can result in a warning from the hostel administration.

Visitors & Guests

Visitors are generally required to register at the hostel reception, and overnight guests are typically not permitted without prior written approval from the hostel administration. Rules around visiting hours for family members differ between male and female residences and are published separately by the hostel office.

15. Health, Safety & Wellness Services

Many campuses maintain a first-aid or medical room staffed during teaching hours to handle minor injuries and sudden illness, and to coordinate onward referral to a hospital for anything more serious. Students experiencing a recurring health concern are encouraged to share relevant information with Student Affairs in confidence, particularly where it might affect attendance or exam scheduling.

Counselling & Mental Health Support

University life brings academic pressure, financial stress, and personal challenges, and students are encouraged to reach out to the counselling or Student Affairs office rather than carrying a difficulty alone. Conversations with a counsellor are treated confidentially, with disclosure outside that relationship limited to situations involving risk to the student's safety or the safety of others, consistent with standard professional practice.

Fire Safety & Evacuation

Each campus building displays evacuation routes and assembly points, and periodic fire drills may be conducted. Students and staff are expected to follow posted evacuation instructions promptly during any drill or real emergency rather than continuing classroom or lab activity.

On a related note, Hamdam is built to recognise when a question signals real distress rather than a routine query, and in those moments it steps out of its usual menu of options to express concern directly and point the student toward Student Affairs, a counsellor, or emergency services rather than continuing with policy explanations.

16. Campus Security & Emergency Procedures

Security personnel are present at campus entrances and across each campus to manage access, verify identification, and respond to incidents. Students, staff, and visitors may be asked to show identification when entering a campus or a restricted area such as a lab or server room, and are expected to comply promptly and courteously.

Reporting an Incident

Theft, vandalism, suspicious behaviour, or any safety concern should be reported immediately to the nearest security post or to the campus security office. For incidents involving harassment or a disciplinary matter, the report should also be shared with Student Affairs so it can be handled through the appropriate policy track described elsewhere in this handbook.

Emergency Contacts

Each campus publishes its own emergency contact numbers for security, the medical room, and facilities management at common areas such as reception desks, notice boards, and the student portal. In a genuine emergency, contacting campus security or local emergency services takes priority over looking up a specific extension number.

17. Transportation & Parking

Several campuses offer a university transport service operating fixed routes between major pick-up points across the city and the relevant campus, on a subscription basis arranged through the transport office at the start of each semester. Route availability and schedules are published separately and may be adjusted between semesters based on demand.

Parking on Campus

Students and staff bringing private vehicles are generally expected to park only in designated parking areas and to follow any campus-specific permit or sticker system. Parking is offered on a best-effort basis and is not guaranteed during peak hours; the university is not responsible for loss or damage to vehicles parked on campus, and any vehicle obstructing emergency access routes or fire lanes may be reported to security.

18. Sports, Co-Curricular Activities & Student Societies

Beyond the classroom, students are encouraged to take part in sports, cultural events, academic societies, and competitions, both as a break from coursework and as a way to develop leadership and teamwork skills that complement a degree. Departments and student societies regularly organise seminars, business plan competitions, hackathons, drama and media festivals, and inter-university sports tournaments.

Forming or Joining a Society

Most departments host one or more student societies aligned with their discipline — for example, business, computing, media, or pharmacy societies — open to students from that department, while a smaller number of societies (such as a debating or community-service society) may be open university-wide. New societies are typically formed with the sponsorship of a faculty advisor and approval from Student Affairs.

Conduct at Events

The same Code of Conduct that applies in a classroom applies at a sports match, a society event, or an inter-university competition representing the university — participants are expected to behave in a way that reflects well on themselves and on the institution, including toward opposing teams, judges, and event organisers.

19. Career Services, Internships & Alumni Relations

The university's Career Services and Placement Support function works to connect students with internships and graduate employment opportunities, including organising career fairs, company visits, CV-writing and interview-preparation workshops, and maintaining relationships with industry partners across sectors relevant to its degree programs.

Internships

Several programs include a mandatory or strongly recommended internship component, generally completed during a semester break, with the department setting minimum duration and reporting requirements (such as a supervisor evaluation and an internship report) needed for the internship to count toward degree requirements.

Alumni Network

Graduates remain part of the university community through alumni relations activities, including guest talks, mentoring current students, and recruitment partnerships that often bring fresh internship and job openings back to current students. Alumni wishing to reconnect or contribute as guest speakers are welcome to reach out through the Alumni Relations or Career Services office.

20. International Programs & Exchange

The university maintains collaborations with international institutions for student exchange programs and joint research initiatives, giving eligible students the opportunity to spend part of their degree studying abroad, subject to the partner institution's own admission and visa requirements. Interested students typically begin by speaking with the International Office or their department about which partnerships are currently active and what eligibility criteria — such as a minimum CGPA — apply.

Incoming International Students

International students joining the university follow a parallel admissions and orientation track coordinated with the International Office, covering visa and immigration documentation, accommodation guidance, and an orientation session that introduces local academic culture and campus services alongside the standard new-student orientation.

21. Faculties & Departments in Detail

The six faculties introduced earlier each bring together several departments. Knowing which faculty your department sits under matters in practice, because academic appeals, course overload approval, and several other processes in this handbook route through your Dean's office, which sits at the faculty level rather than the department level.

Faculty of Business Administration

Home to the university's oldest and most established academic identity, this faculty traces its roots to the original Asian Management Institute program and houses departments covering general management, finance, marketing, human resources, and entrepreneurship, offering undergraduate, MBA, MS, and PhD tracks. It is also the faculty most closely tied to the university's recognition as a top-ranked business school in HEC rankings.

Faculty of Engineering, Sciences & Technology

This faculty covers computing and engineering disciplines, including computer science, software engineering, electrical engineering, and related applied science programs. Lab-based courses here carry additional safety and equipment-use expectations layered on top of the general Code of Conduct and the IT Acceptable Use Policy described earlier in this handbook.

Faculty of Arts, Design, Education & Social Sciences

A broad faculty spanning humanities and social science disciplines as well as design and education programs, this faculty's departments often run studio-based or workshop-style classes where attendance and active participation are even more central to the grading scheme than in a typical lecture course.

Faculty of Health Sciences

Covering disciplines such as psychology, pharmacy, physical therapy, human nutrition and dietetics, and nursing, this faculty's programs typically include clinical or lab placements with their own attendance, dress code, and safety requirements set by the relevant department in addition to the general university rules in this handbook.

Faculty of Media Studies

This faculty houses programs in mass communication, media production, and film studies, often involving practical production work, studio bookings, and equipment checkout that follow the same property-care expectations described in the Use of University Property chapter.

Faculty of Pharmacy

A professional faculty with its own accreditation requirements, regulatory body engagement, and clinical or lab placement components, where students should expect closely monitored attendance and

competency assessments alongside standard coursework.

22. Orientation Week for New Students

Every new cohort begins with an orientation period designed to turn an unfamiliar campus into a navigable one within a few days. While the exact schedule is published separately each intake, orientation generally covers a similar set of building blocks.

- Welcome session with the Dean or a faculty representative, introducing the faculty's departments and key academic staff.
- Campus tour covering classrooms, labs, the Information Resource Centre, the cafeteria, prayer facilities, and administrative offices relevant to a new student.
- Portal and email setup — activating your student login, learning where to check attendance, grades, and fee vouchers, and how to reach your instructors.
- A walkthrough of this handbook's key rules — attendance, examination conduct, fee deadlines, and the Code of Conduct — so nothing here comes as a surprise later in the semester.
- An introduction to student societies and Career Services, so new students know these resources exist long before they might need them.

Hamdam is available throughout orientation week and afterward for quick, repeated questions — new students often ask the same handful of things (where's my classroom, how do I see my schedule, what's my student ID number) multiple times in the first two weeks, and that repetition is exactly the kind of load a virtual assistant is meant to absorb so human staff can focus on less routine questions.

23. Course Registration & Add/Drop: Step by Step

Registering for classes each semester follows a broadly consistent sequence, even though exact portal screens and dates shift year to year.

- Step 1 — Clear any financial or library hold on your account; an outstanding hold typically blocks registration entirely.
- Step 2 — Meet with your academic advisor, particularly in early semesters, to confirm which courses fit your degree plan and any prerequisite chain.
- Step 3 — Register through the student portal during your assigned registration window, selecting sections that don't create a timetable clash.
- Step 4 — Use the add/drop period to fine-tune your schedule; courses dropped within this window are usually eligible for a fee adjustment, while courses dropped after it generally are not.
- Step 5 — Confirm your final registered course list on the portal before the add/drop deadline closes, since instructors finalise class lists and attendance tracking shortly after.

Withdrawing From a Course Later in the Semester

Some programs allow a formal withdrawal after the add/drop period but before a later withdrawal deadline, which usually results in a 'W' notation on the transcript rather than a failing grade, but without a fee refund. After the withdrawal deadline closes, a student remaining registered in a course is assessed normally, including the possibility of a failing grade if performance or attendance falls short.

24. Leave of Absence & Gap Semester Policy

Students who need to pause their studies for a semester or more — due to health, family, financial, or personal circumstances — can apply for an approved leave of absence rather than simply disappearing from registration, which protects their standing and makes re-admission far more straightforward.

Applying for Leave

A leave of absence application is typically submitted to the department or Student Affairs office with a brief explanation and, where relevant, supporting documentation, ideally before the semester in question begins or as early as possible if the need arises mid-semester. Approved leave is recorded formally so the gap does not appear as an unexplained dropout on the student's file.

Returning From Leave

Students returning from an approved leave generally need to confirm their intent to resume studies before the next semester's registration opens, and may need to re-check whether their program's curriculum has changed in their absence, since course requirements are occasionally updated between academic years.

25. Online Learning, LMS & Hybrid Course Policy

Where a course includes an online or hybrid component — recorded lectures, an online discussion forum, or fully remote sessions for part of the semester — it is managed through the university's Learning Management System (LMS), accessible via the student portal.

Attendance in Online Sessions

For live online sessions, attendance is generally recorded through the LMS based on verified participation (such as joining a live session or completing a timed activity), and the same 75% attendance threshold described earlier in this handbook applies regardless of whether a session is delivered in person or online.

Academic Integrity Online

The same prohibition on cheating that applies in a physical examination hall applies to online quizzes and exams — using unauthorised assistance, collaborating where individual work is required, or sharing access to a timed assessment with someone else is treated as an attempt at unfair means under the Examination Rules chapter, regardless of the platform it happens on.

26. Dress Code & Campus Etiquette

Dress code expectations exist to keep the campus feeling like a professional academic environment rather than to police personal style for its own sake. The baseline expectation across campuses is modest, neat attire suitable for a classroom or office setting.

- Avoid clothing with offensive language or imagery, and avoid attire considered overly casual for an academic setting (such as beachwear).
- Lab coats, safety goggles, or other protective equipment are mandatory in specific lab or clinical settings where required by the department, regardless of general dress code rules.
- Formal or business-appropriate attire is generally expected for presentations, internships arranged through the university, viva voce defences, and convocation.

General Campus Etiquette

Keep mobile phones on silent during lectures, arrive on time or quietly if briefly delayed, dispose of litter properly across campus (not only inside the library), and be mindful of noise near classrooms and the IRC even outside class hours, since study spaces are shared by students with different exam schedules throughout the day.

27. Faith, Prayer Facilities & Cultural Life

Campuses typically include a prayer area to support daily prayers during the academic day, and class scheduling generally allows reasonable short breaks around prayer times where feasible. Students observing fasting during Ramadan, religious holidays, or other faith-based practices are encouraged to discuss any related scheduling needs with their instructor in advance rather than after a conflict arises.

Cultural Events

The university calendar includes cultural and religious occasions marked with student society events, seminars, or campus decorations, alongside national days and university milestones such as convocation and founders' commemorations. Students are welcome to propose events through their society or Student Affairs.

28. Cafeteria, Canteen & Food Services

Each campus operates or hosts a cafeteria or canteen offering meals and snacks during teaching hours. Pricing and menus are set by the operating vendor and may differ by campus.

Etiquette & Cleanliness

- Dispose of trays, plates, and waste at designated points rather than leaving them at tables.
- Food and drink are generally not permitted inside classrooms, labs, or the main library reading areas, to protect equipment and shared study space.
- Report any food safety or hygiene concern to the campus facilities office so the vendor can address it quickly.

29. Prohibited Items & Substance Policy

Smoking is prohibited inside academic buildings and is generally restricted to designated outdoor areas where provided, in line with public health regulations governing enclosed public spaces. The possession, use, or distribution of any illegal substance on campus is strictly prohibited, treated as a serious disciplinary matter, and may also be reported to the relevant authorities where required by law.

Weapons & Dangerous Items

Weapons of any kind, including items not legally classified as weapons but capable of causing harm and brought onto campus with that intent, are strictly prohibited. Any such item discovered will be confiscated, and the matter will be escalated immediately to campus security and the Disciplinary Committee.

30. Lost & Found, ID Cards & Campus Cards

Your university ID card is required not only for examinations, as described earlier, but also for everyday campus access, library borrowing, and in some cases attendance verification. Losing it is inconvenient but routine to fix.

Replacing a Lost ID Card

Report the loss to Student Affairs or the relevant administrative office promptly, both to begin the replacement process and to protect yourself if someone else attempts to misuse the lost card. A replacement is typically issued after verification of identity and, in many cases, payment of a small replacement fee.

Lost & Found

Items found on campus are generally handed to campus security or the relevant reception desk. Students who lose a personal item are encouraged to check with security and with the office nearest to where the item was likely lost.

31. Convocation & Degree Conferral

Completing all degree requirements — credit hours, minimum CGPA, and clearance from the library, finance, and other relevant offices — makes a student eligible for graduation, but the degree is formally conferred at convocation, the university's graduation ceremony.

Eligibility & Clearance

Before a student's name is included in a convocation list, the Registrar's Office typically confirms academic completion while the Finance Office and the Information Resource Centre confirm there are no outstanding dues or unreturned library material. Any outstanding clearance issue can delay a student's participation in convocation or release of their final transcript and degree, even if all coursework is complete.

Provisional Certificates

Students who need proof of completion before the formal convocation date — for example, for a job offer or further-study application — can usually request a provisional certificate or degree completion letter from the Registrar's Office once final results are confirmed.

32. Research Ethics, Theses & Plagiarism Detection

Programs that culminate in a thesis, capstone project, or major research paper hold students to the same academic integrity standard described in the Code of Conduct, with some research-specific additions.

Plagiarism Thresholds & Detection

Thesis and major project submissions are typically checked through plagiarism-detection software before a defence or final submission is accepted, with departments setting a maximum acceptable similarity index. Work exceeding that threshold is generally returned for revision before it can proceed, and deliberate, severe plagiarism is treated as a Code of Conduct violation subject to the Disciplinary Actions process.

Supervision & Ethical Approval

Research involving human participants, sensitive data, or lab work with safety implications may require ethical approval from the relevant departmental or faculty research committee before data collection begins. Students should confirm with their supervisor early in the project timeline whether their specific research design needs this kind of approval.

33. Student Government & Representation

Student representation gives the university community a structured channel for student voice beyond individual grievances, typically through class representatives, society leadership, and, where active, a university-wide student council.

Class Representatives

Many sections elect or nominate a class representative early in the semester to act as a liaison between the class and the instructor or department on logistical matters — rescheduling a class, raising a shared concern about pacing, or relaying announcements both ways.

Student Council & Society Leadership

Society offices and, where applicable, student council seats are typically filled through an election or nomination process coordinated with Student Affairs at the start of an academic year, with eligibility usually requiring good academic and disciplinary standing.

34. Email, Portal & Communication Etiquette

Official university communication — announcements, results, fee notices, and instructor correspondence — is sent through the university email and student portal, which makes it important to check both regularly rather than relying solely on informal class group chats.

Writing to Faculty or Staff

- Use your official university email account rather than a personal one when writing to instructors or offices, since official communication is easier to trace and respond to.
- Include your name, student ID, program, and a clear subject line so the recipient can act on your message quickly.
- Keep the tone professional even when the topic is frustrating — a calm, clear message gets resolved faster than an angry one, and is also simply the expectation under the Code of Conduct.

Response Time Expectations

Most offices aim to respond within a few working days; for anything time-sensitive — a fee deadline, an exam conflict, or an urgent personal circumstance — visiting the relevant office in person or calling is usually faster than email alone.

35. Quality Assurance & Institutional Accreditation

The university's degree-granting authority traces back to its charter from the Government of Sindh, and individual programs may carry additional accreditation from relevant bodies — for instance, computing programs have historically held accreditation from the National Computing Education Accreditation Council under the Higher Education Commission. Where a specific professional accreditation matters to a student's career path (such as in pharmacy or engineering), the relevant department can confirm current accreditation status for that program.

Internal Quality Assurance

A Quality Enhancement function typically supports continuous improvement through course evaluations, periodic curriculum review, and feedback surveys completed by students each semester. Student feedback through these official channels is one of the most direct ways a concern about teaching quality or course content reaches the people who can act on it.

36. Sustainability & Campus Environment

Campus operations increasingly factor in sustainability considerations — from energy use in buildings to recycling points and green spaces — reflecting a broader institutional interest in environmental performance alongside academic and research metrics.

What Students Can Do

- Use recycling or waste-segregation points where provided rather than mixing all waste together.
- Report leaking taps, faulty lighting left on overnight, or other resource waste to the facilities office.
- Student societies focused on sustainability or community service are a good route for organising a campus clean-up, tree-planting, or awareness event.

37. Raising a Concern About a Faculty Member

Occasionally a concern is specifically about how a course is being taught or how an instructor is interacting with a class, which calls for a slightly different first step than a general grievance.

Recommended Path

- If comfortable doing so, raise the concern directly and respectfully with the instructor first — many issues are unintentional and easily clarified.
- If that doesn't resolve it, or doesn't feel appropriate for the specific concern, raise it with the department head, who can address it with the instructor directly.
- For concerns involving harassment, discrimination, or a serious ethical breach, use the Anti-Harassment & Anti-Ragging Policy reporting route instead, since that process is designed specifically for those situations.
- End-of-semester course evaluations are also a recognised, semi-anonymous channel for feedback about teaching quality, reviewed by the department and Quality Enhancement function.

38. Student Grievance Redressal Mechanism

Students who have a concern about an academic decision, a member of staff, a facility, or any other aspect of university life have the right to raise it through a clear grievance process rather than having no formal avenue for resolution.

Steps to Raise a Grievance

- Start with the most immediate level — typically the course instructor or relevant office — since many concerns can be resolved quickly and informally at this stage.
- If unresolved, escalate in writing to the department head or the relevant office's supervisor, clearly describing the concern and the resolution sought.
- If still unresolved, escalate to the Dean of the relevant faculty or to Student Affairs, which can convene a review where appropriate.
- Grievances involving harassment, discrimination, or potential disciplinary violations follow the specific reporting routes described in the Anti-Harassment & Anti-Ragging Policy chapter rather than the general grievance process.

What to Expect

A student raising a grievance in good faith is protected from retaliation, and is generally entitled to a response within a reasonable timeframe communicated by whichever office is handling the matter. Anonymous concerns can be submitted through suggestion boxes or an online feedback form where available, though identified complaints are usually easier to investigate and resolve fully.

39. Data Privacy & Student Records Policy

The university collects and stores personal and academic data — admissions documents, attendance, grades, financial records, and disciplinary history — in order to administer a student's education, and is committed to protecting that data from unauthorised access or disclosure.

Who Can Access Student Records

Academic and personal records are generally accessible only to the student themselves, relevant faculty and administrative staff acting in an official capacity, and, with the student's written consent, a parent, guardian, sponsor, or external organisation (such as a scholarship provider) the student has authorised to receive specific information.

Portal Credentials

Each student is issued individual login credentials for the student portal and university email, and is responsible for keeping them confidential. Sharing portal access with another person is both a security risk and a violation of the IT Acceptable Use Policy described earlier in this handbook, since it can expose a student's own grades and personal data as well as create opportunities for academic dishonesty.

Retention

Academic records such as transcripts are retained long-term so that alumni can request transcripts and verification letters years after graduation, while some operational records (such as routine correspondence) may be retained for a shorter, internally defined period.

40. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is the minimum attendance requirement?

A: You must maintain at least 75% attendance in each course individually. Falling below that in any single course can make you ineligible to sit that course's final exam, even if your attendance in other courses is excellent.

Q: I was sick and missed several classes. What should I do?

A: Inform your course instructor as soon as you can and keep your medical certificate. For extended absences, also notify Student Affairs or your department. Approved leave doesn't retroactively raise your attendance percentage, but it can open the door to a makeup arrangement in some cases.

Q: What do I need to bring to an exam?

A: Your university ID card is mandatory for every exam. Bring only permitted stationery and any items explicitly allowed by the course instructor — unauthorised notes or devices can be treated as an attempt at unfair means.

Q: What happens if I'm caught cheating in an exam?

A: It depends on severity. A first minor case usually means cancellation of that paper and a formal warning. More serious or repeated cases can lead to cancellation of the whole semester's result, suspension, or referral to the Disciplinary Committee. You'll always get a chance to explain your side before a final decision.

Q: I missed my final exam for a genuine reason. Can I retake it?

A: Yes, generally — apply for a make-up examination through your department with supporting documentation, usually within a short window after the missed exam.

Q: How is my GPA calculated?

A: Most programs use a 4.0-point scale combining quizzes, assignments, mid-terms, and finals according to the weighting in your course outline. Your semester GPA and overall CGPA both appear on the student portal after results are announced.

Q: What happens if my CGPA drops too low?

A: You'd typically be placed on academic probation, which may include closer advising and a cap on credit hours next semester. Staying below the threshold beyond the probation period can lead to dismissal from the program, though you can appeal.

Q: How long can I keep a library book?

A: Until the due date stamped at checkout. You can usually renew before that date through the IRC online catalogue or the circulation desk, unless another student has placed a hold on it.

Q: What happens if I return a library book late?

A: A per-day fine accrues until you return it. Significant unpaid fines or unreturned items can suspend your future borrowing privileges until the account is cleared.

Q: Can I eat or take calls inside the library?

A: Please keep phones on silent and take calls outside the main reading area, and stick to designated areas for food and drink — the IRC's reading halls are meant to stay quiet for everyone studying there.

Q: When are tuition fees due?

A: Each semester has its own fee voucher and due date published on the student portal. Because exact amounts and dates change every year, please check your current voucher or the Finance Office rather than relying on a fixed date from memory.

Q: What happens if I pay my fee late?

A: A late fee surcharge typically applies, and continued non-payment can trigger a financial hold that blocks registration, exam access, or release of results — so it's best to contact the Finance Office before the deadline if you expect a delay.

Q: Can I get a refund if I drop a course?

A: Possibly, if you withdraw within the add/drop period — refund percentages and timelines are set by the Finance Office each semester. Withdrawing after that window generally isn't eligible for a refund of tuition already due.

Q: How do I apply for a scholarship?

A: Through the Financial Aid or Scholarships desk during the application window announced each academic year. Merit-based scholarships usually look at CGPA or entrance test scores; need-based aid requires documentation of financial hardship.

Q: What's the difference between suspension and expulsion?

A: Suspension removes you from a course, semester, or the university temporarily, for a defined period. Expulsion is permanent removal, reserved for the most serious violations or repeated breaches after prior warnings.

Q: Can I appeal a disciplinary decision?

A: Yes — you can typically file a written appeal to the next level of authority (for example, from a department decision up to the Dean's office) within a set number of days of being notified.

Q: Is ragging really taken seriously, even as a 'joke' or tradition?

A: Yes, completely. Ragging or hazing of any kind, regardless of intent or framing, is strictly prohibited and is handled through the same serious process as other harassment complaints.

Q: Who do I talk to if I'm being harassed by another student?

A: Student Affairs, a trusted faculty member, or your department head — whichever feels safest and most accessible to you. Reports are handled as confidentially as the investigation allows, and

retaliation against you for reporting is itself a violation.

Q: Can I use the campus Wi-Fi for personal streaming or downloads?

A: Campus Wi-Fi and the student portal are meant for academic use. Sharing your login with someone else, or using the network for unlawful content, is against the IT Acceptable Use Policy.

Q: I broke a piece of lab equipment by accident — what now?

A: Report it to the lab in-charge promptly. Damage to university property typically results in a fine or repair cost, but reporting it yourself, quickly, is always better than having it discovered later.

Q: Does the university have hostels?

A: Where university-arranged accommodation exists for a given campus, it follows curfew, cleanliness, and visitor rules set by the hostel administration. Availability differs by campus and year, so check with Student Affairs or the Hostel Administration office for your specific location.

Q: Is there a counsellor I can talk to if I'm struggling mentally?

A: Yes — reach out to the counselling or Student Affairs office. Conversations are kept confidential except where there's a safety risk to you or others.

Q: Does the university provide transport?

A: Several campuses offer a subscription-based transport service on fixed routes, arranged through the transport office at the start of each semester. Check with your campus for current routes.

Q: How do I join a student society?

A: Most departments host subject-specific societies open to their own students, while a few are open university-wide. Reach out to the society directly or to Student Affairs to find out how to join or how to start a new one.

Q: Does the university help with internships and jobs?

A: Yes — Career Services and Placement Support run career fairs, company visits, and CV/interview workshops, and several programs include a mandatory or recommended internship component.

Q: Can I study abroad as part of my degree?

A: Possibly, through the university's exchange partnerships with international institutions, subject to eligibility criteria like a minimum CGPA and the partner institution's own requirements. Start by speaking with the International Office or your department.

Q: How do I raise a complaint that isn't about harassment or discipline?

A: Start at the most immediate level (e.g., your instructor or the relevant office), then escalate in writing to a department head, and finally to the Dean's office or Student Affairs if still unresolved.

Q: Who can see my grades and personal records?

A: You, plus relevant faculty and administrative staff acting officially, and anyone you've given written consent to share information with, such as a parent or scholarship sponsor.

Q: What is the Information Resource Centre?

A: It's the university's library — known as the IRC — holding a large collection of curriculum textbooks, professional and general reading, and government publications, plus access to digital research databases.

Q: Where is the Main Campus located?

A: On Shaheed-e-Millat Road in the Defence View area of Karachi. The university also has other Karachi campuses (including Gulshan and North), plus campuses in Islamabad and Hyderabad.

Q: What happens during orientation week?

A: A welcome session, a campus tour, portal and email setup, a walkthrough of the key rules in this handbook, and an introduction to student societies and Career Services. The exact schedule is published separately for each new intake.

Q: How do I register for courses each semester?

A: Clear any financial or library hold, meet your academic advisor if needed, register through the student portal in your assigned window, then use the add/drop period to adjust your schedule before the deadline closes.

Q: What's the difference between dropping a course and withdrawing from it?

A: Dropping within the add/drop period usually comes with a fee adjustment and no transcript trace. Withdrawing later, before the withdrawal deadline, usually leaves a 'W' on your transcript without a refund. After the withdrawal deadline, you're graded normally.

Q: Can I take a semester off without losing my place?

A: Yes — apply for an approved leave of absence through your department or Student Affairs, ideally before the semester starts. This keeps your file in good order and makes returning straightforward.

Q: Does attendance still matter for online or recorded classes?

A: Yes. The same 75% threshold applies whether a session is in person or online, and online attendance is generally tracked through the LMS based on verified participation.

Q: Is there a dress code?

A: Yes, modest and neat attire suitable for an academic or office setting is expected, with stricter requirements (like lab coats or safety gear) in specific labs or clinical settings, and more formal attire expected for presentations, defences, and convocation.

Q: Is there a prayer area on campus?

A: Yes, campuses typically include a prayer area, and class scheduling generally allows for short breaks around prayer times where feasible.

Q: I lost my student ID card — what do I do?

A: Report it to Student Affairs or the relevant administrative office right away. A replacement is usually issued after identity verification and a small replacement fee.

Q: What does my thesis need to pass a plagiarism check?

A: Your department sets a maximum acceptable similarity index using plagiarism-detection software. Work above that threshold is typically sent back for revision before it can proceed to defence or final submission.

Q: I have a concern about how a class is being taught — what should I do?

A: Raise it directly and respectfully with the instructor first if you're comfortable doing so. If that doesn't help, go to the department head. End-of-semester course evaluations are also a recognised channel for this kind of feedback.

Q: What clears me for convocation?

A: Completing your credit hours and minimum CGPA, plus clearance from the Finance Office and the Information Resource Centre confirming no outstanding dues or unreturned books. Any one of these being incomplete can delay your participation.

41. Hamdam: Sample Conversations & Response Guidelines

This chapter is written specifically for whoever configures or trains Hamdam — it shows the tone the assistant should aim for across a range of situations, from routine questions to sensitive ones.

Routine Question

Student: “can i still register for a course, add/drop deadline ka pta nahi mujhe”

Hamdam: “No worries! The add/drop deadline is published on the academic calendar on your student portal each semester, and it changes slightly year to year, so I'd rather point you to the exact date there than guess. Want me to tell you where on the portal to look?”

Policy Question With a Real Consequence

Student: “my attendance is 70% in one subject, can I still give the final?”

Hamdam: “Based on the standard policy, 75% attendance per course is required to sit that course's final exam, so 70% would normally make you ineligible. There can occasionally be an exception process through your department for documented emergencies — I'd suggest talking to your department or Student Affairs directly and soon, since this is time-sensitive.”

Sensitive / Distress Situation

Student: “i feel like nobody would notice if i just disappeared from this university”

Hamdam: “I'm really glad you told me this, and I want you to know it matters. This isn't something I want to just answer with a policy — please reach out to the university counselling service or Student Affairs office as soon as you can, or talk to someone you trust right now. If you're in immediate danger, please contact local emergency services. I'm here, but a counsellor or someone close to you can help in a way I can't.”

When the Assistant Doesn't Know

Hamdam never invents a fee amount, a deadline, or a named staff contact it isn't sure of. Its fallback line in that situation is some version of: “I don't want to give you a number I'm not fully sure of — let's get you to [the right office] so you have the exact current figure.”

Closing a Conversation

Hamdam keeps sign-offs short and doesn't pressure a student to keep chatting: “Glad that helped! Good luck with your exam.” or “Anytime — come back if anything else comes up.”

42. Glossary of Terms

- HEC — Higher Education Commission of Pakistan, the national body that charters and regulates universities and accredits specific programs.
- IRC — Information Resource Centre, the formal name of the university library.
- GPA / CGPA — Grade Point Average for a single semester / Cumulative Grade Point Average across all semesters completed so far.
- Add/Drop Period — the early window in a semester during which a student can change their course registration, usually with eligibility for a fee refund.
- Academic Probation — a status applied when CGPA falls below a program's minimum threshold, involving closer advising and sometimes a reduced course load.
- Financial Hold — a restriction placed on a student's account for unpaid dues, which can block registration, exam access, or release of results.
- Disciplinary Committee — the body responsible for reviewing serious violations of the Code of Conduct and recommending or deciding on a sanction.
- Unfair Means — the examination department's term for cheating or any attempt to gain an unfair advantage during an assessment.
- Credit Hour — the unit used to measure course workload and to determine full-time or part-time student status.
- Student Portal — the online system where students check attendance, grades, fee vouchers, and academic calendars.

43. Contact Directory

For anything specific to your own program, campus, or case, the offices below are your starting points. Exact phone extensions, emails, and office hours for individual departments are best confirmed through the student portal or campus reception, since they can change between academic years.

- Iqra University — general website: iqra.edu.pk
- Main Campus — Shaheed-e-Millat Road, Phase 2, Defence View Housing Society, Karachi. General university contact numbers are published on the official website and on campus notice boards.
- Registrar's Office — academic records, transcripts, registration, and official certificates.
- Finance Office — fee vouchers, deadlines, refunds, and financial holds.
- Examination Department — exam scheduling, result queries, re-checking, and make-up exams.
- Information Resource Centre (Library) — borrowing, renewals, research support, and digital access.
- Student Affairs — grievances, counselling referrals, hostel coordination, and general student welfare matters.
- Career Services & Placement Support — internships, career fairs, and recruitment partnerships.
- International Office — exchange programs and incoming international student support.
- Campus Security — incident reporting and on-campus emergencies.

This handbook is an expanded reference and chatbot knowledge-base document prepared to give a virtual assistant rich context about campus life, policies, and tone of voice. Historical facts about Iqra University (founding, campuses, faculties, and the Information Resource Centre) are drawn from public university sources. Operational details such as exact fee amounts, deadlines, office hours, and contact extensions change from one academic year to the next, so they are described here in general terms. Students and staff should always confirm current figures with the Registrar's Office, the Finance Office, or the official student portal before relying on them for an academic or financial decision.